AXEL: Resonance — Master Build Prompt (Full Steam Release)

For: Fresh Claude Code session, after AXEL: ZERO validates K-factor. **Goal:** Ship a Steam-quality cascading-cluster slot roguelite with cosmic/neon aesthetic in 3–4 weeks. **Philosophy:** Beat CloverPit + Slots & Daggers to the cascading-cluster lane.

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1. Project Overview

AXEL: Resonance — a Steam-shippable roguelite where you run through cosmic biomes (Nebula → Quasar → Void → Supercluster), each ante a cascading-cluster slot spin with biome-specific items. Visual peak: the "supernova" max-multiplier moment.

Why this wins:

- Cluster-cascade-in-roguelite niche unoccupied (CloverPit = 1-armed bandit; LBL = single-spin; Cascadou = cards)
- Vector visuals = no art-team bottleneck → solo-buildable
- Cosmic aesthetic differentiates from CloverPit-grunge and Slots & Daggers-fantasy
- Genre is rising/peak (6–12 week window)

Legal: Mechanics from Moon Princess 100 are SAFE (industry-standard since 2016). All naming/visuals/themes are original.

2. Context Window Management

- **Session 1:** Cascade engine + vector renderer (Phase 1)
- **Session 2:** Run loop + biome system (Phase 2)
- **Session 3:** Items + balance (Phase 3)
- **Session 4:** Steam integration + meta (Phase 4)
- **Session 5:** Polish + launch (Phase 5)

3. Tech Stack

- **Engine:** Godot 4 (lighter than Unity, free, great for 2D, easy Steam export)
    - Alternative: Web → Tauri/Electron desktop wrap (faster if you're web-native)
- **Rendering:** Vector + GPU particles (Godot's GPUParticles2D)
- **Save:** Local JSON
- **Steamworks:** GodotSteam plugin for achievements + leaderboards

- **Audio:** Free packs (freesound, GameDev Market subscription)

4. Reusable Code Reference

- AXEL: ZERO cascade engine (port the algorithms, re-render with vectors)
- Biome content authoring: pattern from any Hades-clone tutorial

5. Segmented TODO List

PHASE 1 — VECTOR CASCADE ENGINE (Session 1, ~5 days)

- ☐ Godot project setup, scene graph
- ☐ Port `findClusters` / `resolveCascade` from AXEL: ZERO
- ☐ Vector symbol rendering (parametric shapes + glow shader)
- ☐ Particle system for cascade events
- ☐ **Resonance Field meter** (ramps within a spin, visual glow intensifies)
- ☐ "Supernova" max-multiplier moment: full-screen visual when multiplier hits cap during a cascade

PHASE 2 — BIOMES + RUN LOOP (Session 2, ~5 days)

- ☐ Biome data structure: symbol pool override, item pool, RTP target, ante curve
- ☐ 4 biomes: Nebula, Quasar, Void, Supercluster
- ☐ Run map: biome → 4–6 antes → shop → next biome
- ☐ Boss ante per biome (higher target, special modifier)
- ☐ Game state: items, deck, biome history

PHASE 3 — ITEMS + BALANCE (Session 3, ~5 days)

- ☐ ~40 items across biomes (10 per biome + 5 universal × 2 rarity)
- ☐ Synergy framework: items declare tags + triggers; engine matches at spin events
- ☐ RTP tuning per biome: target ~85–92% with rising variance
- ☐ Difficulty curve playtest
- ☐ Daily seed mode (reuse from ZERO if extant)

PHASE 4 — STEAM + META (Session 4, ~4 days)

- ☐ GodotSteam integration
- ☐ Achievements (~20)
- ☐ Steam leaderboards (daily seed)
- ☐ Steam Cloud save
- ☐ Workshop NOT in v1 (cut scope)

- [ ] Steam Capsule art (vector design, no commission)
- [ ] Trailer (60s, cascade-heavy)

PHASE 5 — POLISH + LAUNCH (Session 5, ~4 days)

- [ ] Sound design pass
- [ ] Music: commission 4 biome tracks or use royalty-free
- [ ] Tutorial
- [ ] Settings menu, keybinds
- [ ] Steam page copy
- [ ] Launch + 20% launch discount

6. Game-Specific Details

Symbol pool per biome: 6 symbols, biome-themed (Nebula = stars/dust, Quasar = beams/photons, etc.) **Resonance Field meter:** 1× → 2× → 5× → 10× → SUPERNOVA (25× + full-screen visual + bonus) **Grid-clear:** Triggers 3 free spins with carryover Resonance + biome-specific bonus

Pricing: $9.99 launch, $12.99 regular (matches Slots & Daggers, LBL post-EA) **Target reviews:** 90%+ positive in first 30 days

7. Critical Reminders

- ❌ No princess theming. No "Moon" references. No "Trinity" naming.
- ❌ No real-money or simulated-cash framing in marketing
- ✅ Lead with **cascade clip** in trailer and Steam page video
- ✅ Daily seed leaderboard = retention/competition driver
- ✅ Ship at 3–4 weeks even if 80% polished. Patch after launch.

8. Launch Checklist

- [ ] Steam page live 2 weeks before release (for wishlists)
- [ ] Submit to Steam Next Fest if timing allows
- [ ] Outreach to Northernlion, Olexa, Retromation (Balatro/CloverPit-friendly streamers)
- [ ] Post-launch: weekly patch cadence for first 8 weeks
- [ ] Mobile F2P port: scoped after 3 months IF Steam K > 0.5